

PREMIUM RESOURCE · AI & FINANCE AUTOMATION

Power Automate Flow Templates for Finance

5 Power Automate flow templates for finance — invoice approval routing, expense policy alert, month-end reminder, KPI breach alert, and budget overrun notification. Includes flow definition JSON files and a full build guide.

5 Flow Templates

JSON Flow Definitions

Full Build Guide

Premium · €45

5

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WHAT THESE JSON FILES ACTUALLY ARE — READ THIS FIRST

Each JSON file is a genuine Power Automate flow definition, written in Workflow Definition Language (WDL) — the same schema Power Automate itself uses internally and exports to. They are **not** a one-click "import and go" package. A real Power Automate import requires connection references bound to your specific tenant's live connectors, which cannot be pre-filled generically in a file like this — the same is true even for flows exported directly from a working environment. Section 1 explains exactly how to use these files productively.

SECTION 1

How to Use These JSON Files

Two genuine paths from a JSON file on your computer to a working flow in your own tenant — neither of them is a plain drag-and-drop, and both are covered here.

Path A — Use the JSON as an Exact Blueprint (Recommended for Most Teams)

Build the flow by hand in the Power Automate designer, using the JSON file as a precise reference for exactly which trigger, conditions, and actions to add, in what order, with what logic — rather than guessing at the structure yourself or relying on memory of a demo.

1 Open the JSON file alongside the Power Automate designer

Any text editor works — you're reading it, not editing it directly.

2 Add the trigger shown at the top of the "triggers" object

Match the connector and list/table name to your own SharePoint site or data source.

3 Add each action in the “actions” object, in order

The “runAfter” field on each action tells you exactly what must complete before it — this is your sequencing guide.

4 Recreate each “If” condition using its “expression” field

This maps directly to the condition builder's field/operator/value inputs in the designer.

5 Replace every placeholder value

Anything shown in capitals (e.g. YOUR_SHAREPOINT_SITE_URL, ap-team@yourcompany.com) is a placeholder — replace it with your actual site, list, channel, and email details.

Path B — Package as a Solution (For IT / Power Platform Admins)

If your organisation manages Power Automate through solutions, an administrator can use these JSON files as the starting definition for a proper solution package, then bind the connection references to your tenant's actual connectors using the Power Platform CLI or the maker portal.

- ☐ Create a new (or use an existing) unmanaged solution in your target environment.
- ☐ Add a new flow to the solution and paste the JSON structure into the flow's definition via the designer's code view, where available, or rebuild it using Path A inside the solution.
- ☐ Re-map every entry in “connectionReferences” to a real, existing connection in your tenant — this step cannot be skipped or automated generically.
- ☐ Test thoroughly in a non-production environment before exporting the solution for deployment to Production.

Why not just provide a ready-made .zip: A solution .zip is only valid for the exact tenant, connector versions, and connection GUIDs it was exported from. A generic .zip claiming universal compatibility would fail on import or silently reference connections that don't exist in your environment — worse than a JSON file you can read and rebuild from deliberately.

SECTION 2

The 5 Flow Templates

Each flow's trigger, logic, and connectors, with the matching JSON filename and a real excerpt from the file so you can see the exact structure before you open it.

01

Invoice Approval Routing

Routes invoices above a threshold for manager approval; auto-approves the rest.

`01_Invoice_Approval_Routing.json`

TRIGGER

SharePoint — **When an item is created**, on an Invoices list with columns for VendorName, InvoiceNumber, and Amount.

LOGIC

- A condition checks whether Amount exceeds \$10,000.
- If yes: look up the submitter's manager, start an approval assigned to them, then branch again on the approval outcome to update the item's Status and notify the right person.
- If no: update the item to "Auto-Approved" and notify the AP team it's ready to post.

CONNECTORS USED

SharePoint, Office 365 Users (Get manager V2), Approvals, Office 365 Outlook.

FROM THE JSON FILE

```
"Check_high_value": {
  "type": "If",
  "expression": {
    "greater": ["@triggerBody()?['Amount']", 10000]
  },
  "actions": { ... },
  "else": { "actions": { ... } }
}
```

02 Expense Policy Alert

Flags expense submissions that breach a category threshold or fall in a restricted category.

02_Expense_Policy_Alert.json

TRIGGER

SharePoint — **When an item is created**, on an Expense Reports list with Amount and Category columns.

LOGIC

- A condition checks whether Amount exceeds \$500 or Category equals a restricted value (e.g. "Alcohol").
- If yes: mark the item "Flagged for Review," post an alert to a compliance Teams channel, then look up and email the submitter's manager.
- If no: mark the item "Compliant" and take no further action.

CONNECTORS USED

SharePoint, Microsoft Teams, Office 365 Users (Get manager V2), Office 365 Outlook.

FROM THE JSON FILE

```
"Check_policy_violation": {
  "type": "If",
  "expression": {
    "or": [
      { "greater": ["@triggerBody()?['Amount']", 500] },
      { "equals": ["@triggerBody()?['Category']", "Alcohol"] }
    ]
  }
}
```

03 Month-End Close Reminder

Reminds close-task owners individually and posts an outstanding-tasks summary on a schedule.

03_Month_End_Reminder.json

TRIGGER

Recurrence — monthly, fixed to the 25th of each month.

LOGIC

- Get all items from a Close Tasks list where Status is not "Complete."
- Loop over each incomplete task and email its individual owner a reminder.
- After the loop finishes, post a one-line summary (count of outstanding tasks) to the Finance Close Teams channel.

CONNECTORS USED

Recurrence (built-in), SharePoint, Office 365 Outlook, Microsoft Teams.

FROM THE JSON FILE

```
"Apply_to_each_task": {
  "type": "Foreach",
  "foreach": "@outputs('Get_incomplete_close_tasks')?['body/value']",
  "actions": { "Send_reminder_to_task_owner": { ... } }
}
```

04

KPI Breach Alert

Checks every tracked KPI daily and alerts the owner when one is outside its agreed tolerance.

[04_KPI_Breach_Alert.json](#)

TRIGGER

Recurrence — daily, run early each morning.

LOGIC

- Get all rows from a KPI Tracking list, each with CurrentValue, VariancePercent, ToleranceThreshold, and OwnerEmail.
- Loop over each KPI record.
- For each one, check whether VariancePercent exceeds ToleranceThreshold; if so, alert the finance leadership Teams channel and email the KPI owner directly.

CONNECTORS USED

Recurrence (built-in), SharePoint, Microsoft Teams, Office 365 Outlook.

FROM THE JSON FILE

```
"Check_KPI_breach": {
  "type": "If",
  "expression": {
    "greater": [
      "@items('Apply_to_each_KPI')?['VariancePercent']",
      "@items('Apply_to_each_KPI')?['ToleranceThreshold']"
    ]
  }
}
```

05

Budget Overrun Notification

Calculates variance on every budget update and alerts the right people once it crosses 10%.

[05_Budget_Overrun_Notification.json](#)

TRIGGER

SharePoint — **When an item is created or modified**, on a Budget Tracking list with BudgetAmount and ActualSpend columns.

LOGIC

- Calculate variance percentage as $(\text{ActualSpend} - \text{BudgetAmount}) / \text{BudgetAmount} \times 100$, using a Compose action.
- Check whether that variance exceeds a 10% tolerance.
- If it does: look up the budget owner's manager, email both the owner and manager with the specifics, and post an alert to the finance leadership Teams channel.

CONNECTORS USED

SharePoint, Office 365 Users (Get manager V2), Office 365 Outlook, Microsoft Teams.

FROM THE JSON FILE

```
"Calculate_variance_percent": {
  "type": "Compose",
  "inputs": "@mul(div(sub(triggerBody()?['ActualSpend'],
    triggerBody()?['BudgetAmount']),
    triggerBody()?['BudgetAmount']), 100)"
}
```

SECTION 3

Technical Reference — Reading the JSON

A short primer on the Workflow Definition Language structure, for anyone who wants to read or adapt the files directly rather than only rebuilding via the designer.

Top-Level Structure

Key	What It Holds
properties.displayName	The flow's name as it will appear in Power Automate.
properties.definition	The actual Workflow Definition Language (WDL) object — triggers, actions, parameters, outputs.
properties.connectionReferences	A map of logical connector names used in the flow to the specific connection that must exist in your tenant.
definition.triggers	Exactly one trigger object that starts the flow.
definition.actions	Every step after the trigger, each a named object.

Reading a Single Action

Every action follows the same shape: a **type** that tells the engine what kind of step it is, **inputs** that configure it, and **runAfter** that names which prior actions must finish — and with what result — before this one runs.

```
"Update_item_Approved": {
  "type": "OpenApiConnection",
  "inputs": { ... },
  "runAfter": {
    "Start_and_wait_for_an_approval": ["Succeeded"]
  }
}
```

Reading an Expression

Expressions inside **"If"** actions describe the condition using function names as JSON keys — **greater**, **equals**, **or**, and similar — with the values being compared as an array.

```
"expression": {
  "greater": [
    "@triggerBody()?['Amount']",
    10000
  ]
}
```

Common pitfall: Don't hand-edit a JSON file and expect it to import unchanged. Even a syntactically perfect edit still needs its connection references bound to real connections in the target tenant — treat these files as a precise reference for rebuilding or solution packaging, not as a finished artifact to drop into a live environment.

WHERE TO START

If your team is new to reading flow JSON, start with the Month-End Close Reminder template — it's the most linear of the five (no nested conditions), making it the easiest one to trace from JSON to designer step by step before tackling the approval-routing flows.

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CUSTOM FLOW BUILD SUPPORT

For hands-on support adapting these templates to your own systems, or building additional finance-specific flows from scratch — a bespoke engagement is available on request.

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